Project 1: Nigerian Food Prices, Jan 2017 to Nov 2021 (Excel)

Source: National Bureau of Statistics (NBS), Nigeria

QUESTION

How did Nigerian food prices change, which items rose fastest since Jan 2020, and which states have the highest and lowest prices?

DATA

43 food items, 59 months of average prices (Jan 2017 to Nov 2021), plus the state with the highest and lowest price for each item.

CLEANING LOG

1. Date headers had lost their year when the file opened in Excel, so I rebuilt them as 2017-01 to 2021-11.
2. Deleted one blank row and one source-note row.
3. Checked every price column: no missing months for the 43 items.
4. Split the Lowest and Highest columns (for example "Borno (411.67)") into separate State and Price columns.
5. Added a Category column (10 groups) and two change columns: % change since Jan 2020 and since Jan 2017.
6. Kept the two egg rows separate because they use different units (medium egg tray and a single egg).

KEY FINDINGS

1. On average, food prices rose 40% between Jan 2020 and Nov 2021.
2. Gari white rose the most (89%), followed by yellow maize (83%), white maize (83%), yellow gari (81%) and white beans (77%).
3. By category, beans (74.5%), tubers such as gari and yam (65.3%) and oils (65.0%) rose the most. Fish (23.6%), dairy (25.6%) and meat (28.1%) rose the least.
4. In the latest month of the data, Abuja had the highest price for 9 of the 43 items. Bayelsa, Ebonyi and Abia each had 5.
5. Bauchi had the lowest price for 10 items, followed by Taraba (5) and Adamawa (4).

TAKEAWAY

The biggest price increases hit basic staples (beans, gari, maize and cooking oil), while fish, dairy and meat rose much less. Anyone tracking food affordability should watch staple prices first.

LIMITATIONS

Data ends in Nov 2021. Averages are simple averages across items, not weighted by how much people buy. State information covers only the highest and lowest price for each item, not all states.

TOOLS USED

Excel: Tables, formulas (IFERROR, AVERAGE, INDEX/MATCH, LEFT/FIND/MID), PivotTables, charts.

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Items Tracked	43
Average Rise Since Jan 2020	40%
Biggest Riser	Gari white,sold loose
Biggest Riser, % Change	89%





